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SECURITY



Hackers are trying to steal passwords and sensitive data from users of Signal clone

Hackers are targeting a previously reported bug in the Signal clone app [TeleMessage](#) in an effort to steal users' private data, according to security researchers and a U.S. government agency.

TeleMessage, which earlier this year was revealed to be used by high-ranking officials in the Trump administration, [already experienced at least one data breach in May](#). The company [markets](#) modified versions of Signal, WhatsApp, and Telegram for corporations and government agencies that need to archive chats for legal and compliance reasons.

On Thursday, [GreyNoise](#), a cybersecurity firm with IMAGE CREDITS:
THOMAS HOUTSCHEL / PHOTOTHER / GETTY IMAGES visibility into what hackers are doing on the internet thanks to its network of sensors, [published a post](#) warning that it has seen several attempts to exploit the flaw in TeleMessage, which was originally disclosed in May.

If hackers are able to exploit the vulnerability against their targets, they could access “plaintext usernames, passwords, and other sensitive data,” according to the firm.

“I was left in disbelief at the simplicity of this exploit,” GreyNoise researcher [Howdy Fisher wrote in a post](#) analyzing the flaw. “[A]fter some digging, I found that many devices are still open and vulnerable to this.”

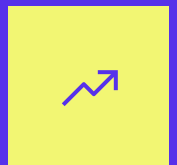
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According to the researcher, exploiting this flaw is “trivial,” and it seems that hackers have taken notice.

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Do you have more information about these attacks? Or about TeleMessage? We’d love to hear from you. From a non-work device and network, you can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Telegram and Keybase @lorenzofb, or [email](#).

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In early July, U.S. cybersecurity agency CISA listed the flaw — designated officially as [CVE-2025-48927](#) — to its catalog of Known Exploited Vulnerabilities, a database that collects security bugs that are known to have been exploited by hackers.

In other words, CISA says hackers are successfully exploiting this bug. At this point, however, no hacks against TeleMessage customers have been publicly reported.

In May, TeleMessage, which at that point was a little-known alternative to Signal, became a household name after then-U.S. National Security Advisor Mike Waltz [accidentally revealed he was using the app](#). Waltz had previously added a journalist to a highly sensitive group chat with other Trump administration officials, where the group [discussed plans to bomb Yemen](#), an operational security snafu that caused a scandal [leading to Waltz’s ousting](#).

After TeleMessage was identified as the app Waltz and others in the administration used to communicate, the company was hacked. Unknown attackers stole the contents of users’ private

messages and group chats, including from Customs and Border Protection, and the cryptocurrency giant Coinbase, [according to 404 Media](#), which first reported the hack.

TeleMessage did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Topics: [bugs](#) [CISA](#) [cybersecurity](#) [GreyNoise](#)

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Hackers exploiting SharePoint zero-day

seen targeting government agencies

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 12:42 PM PDT · July 21, 2025

The hackers behind the [initial wave of attacks exploiting a zero-day in Microsoft SharePoint servers](#) have so far primarily targeted government organizations, according to researchers and news reports.

Over the weekend, U.S. cybersecurity agency CISA [published an alert](#), warning that hackers were exploiting a previously unknown bug — known as a “[zero-day](#)” — in Microsoft’s enterprise data management product SharePoint. While it’s still too early to draw definitive conclusions, it appears that the hackers who first started abusing this flaw were targeting government organizations, according to Silas Cutler, the principal researcher at Censys, a cybersecurity firm that monitors hacking activities on the internet.

IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN / TECHCRUNCH

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Now that the vulnerability is out there, and is still not fully patched by Microsoft, it's possible other hackers that are not necessarily working for a government will join in and start abusing it, Cutler said.

Cutler added that he and his colleagues are seeing between 9,000 and 10,000 vulnerable SharePoint instances accessible from the internet, but that could change. Eye Security, which first [published the existence of the bug](#), reported seeing a similar number, saying its researchers scanned more than 8,000 SharePoint servers worldwide and found evidence of dozens of compromised servers.

Given the limited number of targets and the types of targets at the beginning of the campaign, Cutler explained, it is likely that the hackers were part of a government group, commonly known as an [advanced persistent threat](#).

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[The Washington Post reported](#) on Sunday that the attacks targeted U.S. federal and state agencies, as well as universities and energy companies, among other commercial targets.

Microsoft [said in a blog post](#) that the vulnerability only affects versions of SharePoint that are installed on local networks, and not the cloud versions, which means that each organization that deploys a SharePoint server needs to apply the patch or disconnect it from the internet.

Topics: [apt](#) [CISA](#) [cybersecurity](#) [hackers](#) [hacking](#)

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Zero-days for hacking WhatsApp are now worth millions of dollars

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 7:05 AM PDT · October 5, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS:

NIHARIKA KULKARNI/NURPHOTO VIA GETTY IMAGES
/ GETTY IMAGES

Thanks to improvements in security mechanisms and mitigations, hacking cell phones — both running iOS and Android — has become an expensive endeavor. That's why hacking

techniques for apps like WhatsApp are now worth millions of dollars, TechCrunch has learned.

Last week, a Russian company that buys zero-days — flaws in software that are unknown to the developer of the affected product — [offered \\$20 million for chains of bugs](#) that would allow their customers, which the company said are “Russian private and government organizations only,” to remotely compromise phones running iOS and Android. That price is in part likely caused by the fact that there aren’t many researchers willing to work with Russia while the invasion of Ukraine continues, and that Russian government customers are likely willing to pay a premium under the current circumstances.

But even in the markets outside of Russia, including just for bugs in specific apps, prices have gone up.

Leaked documents seen by TechCrunch show that, as of 2021, a zero-day allowing its user to compromise a target’s WhatsApp on Android and read the content of messages can cost between \$1.7 and \$8 million.

“They’ve shot up,” said a security researcher who has knowledge of the market, and asked to remain anonymous as they weren’t authorized to speak to the press.

WhatsApp has been a popular target for government hackers, the kind of groups that are more likely to use zero-days. In 2019, researchers caught customers of the controversial spyware maker NSO Group [using a zero-day to target WhatsApp users](#). Soon after, WhatsApp [sued the Israeli surveillance tech vendor](#), accusing it of abusing its platform to facilitate its customers using the zero-day against more than a thousand WhatsApp users.

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In 2021, according to one of the leaked documents, a company was selling a “zero click RCE” in WhatsApp for around \$1.7 million. RCE is cybersecurity lingo for remote code execution, a type of flaw that allows malicious hackers to remotely run code on the target’s device. Or in this case, inside WhatsApp, allowing them to monitor, read and exfiltrate messages. “Zero click” refers to the fact that the exploit requires no interaction from the target, making it stealthier and harder to detect.

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The document said the exploit worked for Android versions 9 to 11, which was released in 2020, and that it took advantage of a flaw in the “image rendering library.” In 2020 and 2021, WhatsApp [fixed](#) three [vulnerabilities](#) — CVE-2020-1890, CVE-2020-1910 and CVE-2021-24041 — that all involved how the app processes images. It's unclear if these patches fixed the flaws underlying the exploits that were on sale in 2021.

WhatsApp spokesperson Zade Alsawah said the company declined to comment.

The value of targeting WhatsApp specifically is that, sometimes, government hackers — think those working for intelligence or law enforcement agencies — may only be interested in a target's chats on WhatsApp, so they don't need to compromise the whole phone. But an exploit only in WhatsApp can also be part of a chain to further compromise the target's device.

“The exploit buyers are interested in the exploits for what they enable — spying on their targets,” said a security researcher with knowledge of the market, who asked to remain anonymous to discuss sensitive issues. “If the exploit they buy does not give them all of what they want they need to buy multiple pieces and combine them.”

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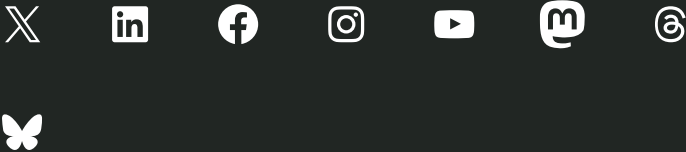


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